

buy it to keep them well within their profit zones. — **Linsey Knerl**

6 Ways to Avoid Tricky Traps at the Supermarket

Going to the supermarket and sticking to a list is an exercise in discipline and requires fortitude and resilience of epic proportions. Employing tips like “don’t shop when you’re hungry,” “look for the no-name brand,” and “avoid the checkout counter displays” are simply damage control for an experience that categorically breaks the budget.

But most of us still need to shop, and supermarkets often offer the best prices and selection. In some cases, the supermarket is all we have. Here are six tips on how to get in and get out without going over your budget:

1. Put blinders on

Staple foods (like eggs and milk) are often located at the back of the store. And for good reason: The only way

to get there is to walk through aisles upon aisles of temptation. If all you need is a quart of milk, then do not allow yourself to get sidetracked by an “amazing deal” on something you don’t really need.

2. Be wary of amazing deals

Many people (myself included) look for sales, and will often formulate the week’s menu accordingly. However, the supermarket marketing gurus are on to us. When your eyes scan the shelves looking for the sale stickers, take a peek at the original price before you decide that it’s a steal; you may find that the amazing deal is a discount of a whole whopping 8 cents. Now I’m all for a deal, but 8 cents is not enough incentive to buy that can of corn for a dish I may not have otherwise used the corn for.

3. That special display is just for show

The gondolas (displays at the end of each aisle, and racks of product hung where shelves join) and other special displays—be they seasonal promotions or just a mountain of cases of pop in the middle of the floor—are also tricky traps. You may automatically assume that they are featuring sale items, since they are prominently displayed